INFO – RASHAN (1-Topic-in-1-Page)

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TOPIC 1 | GS-I | Society – Tribes; Endangered Languages

Kurumbas of Attappady: A PVTG Struggling to Keep Its Oral Language Alive

CONTEXT: The **Kurumba language** of Kerala's **Kurumba PVTG** is at risk of **fading away**.

2,719	19	5	<10,000
Population (2024)	Settlements (Oors)	PVTGs in Kerala	Speakers → 'Others'

1. People
- Attappady, Palakkad
- PVTG
- Palu Kurumbas

2. Ooru system
- Mooppan – head
- Kuruthala – deputy
- Vandari – treasurer

3. Language
- Southern Dravidian
- No script
- Oral tradition

4. Threats
- Migration
- Malayalam shift
- Census 'Others'

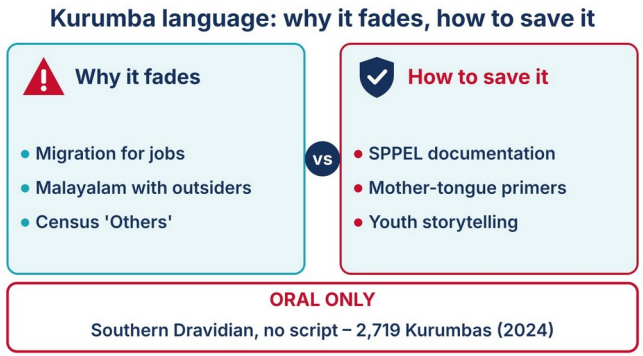


Illustration: why the Kurumba language is fading – and the steps that can keep it alive.

KEY TERMS
PVTG: Most vulnerable tribe
Oor: Kurumba hamlet
SPPEL: Saves languages

PRELIMS HOOK
Kurumbas – PVTG of Attappady (Palakkad, Kerala); one of Kerala's 5 PVTGs; Kurumba = Southern Dravidian, oral, no script; Census puts languages with < 10,000 speakers under 'Others'; SPPEL (CIIL) documents it.

MAINS ANGLE
Tribal identity, language shift and cultural preservation.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "When a language dies, a way of seeing the world dies with it." Discuss with reference to India's small tribal languages. (150 words)

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TOPIC 2 | GS-I | Geography – Places in News (Mapping); Protected Areas

Buxa Tiger Reserve: A Tigress Escapes Her Enclosure in the Dooars

CONTEXT: A **relocated tigress** escaped her enclosure at **Buxa Tiger Reserve**, West Bengal.

~760 sq km Area	**1983** 15th Tiger Reserve	**284+** Bird species	**6** Kunki elephants deployed

1. Where
- Alipurduar, WB
- Bhutan to north
- Assam to east

2. History
- Tiger Reserve 1983
- Sanctuary 1986
- Buxa Fort

3. Landscape
- Terai–Dooars
- Sankosh, Raidak
- Mahakal Caves

4. Wildlife
- Hornbills, florican
- Clouded leopard
- Tigers from Valmiki



Photo: forest of Buxa Tiger Reserve with the Bhutan hills behind.

Photo: Swaroop Singha Roy, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0

KEY TERMS

Kunki: Trained elephant
Dooars: Foothill 'doors'
Stromatolite: Microbe-built rock

PRELIMS HOOK

Buxa Tiger Reserve – Alipurduar (West Bengal), Terai–Dooars; Bhutan (Sinchula range) to the north, Assam to the east; 15th Tiger Reserve (1983); rivers Sankosh, Raidak, Jayanti; tigers relocated from Valmiki.

MAINS ANGLE

Tiger relocation, corridors and human–wildlife conflict.

PRACTICE (MAINS): What lessons does the escape of a relocated tigress at Buxa offer for tiger reintroduction programmes? (150 words)

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TOPIC 3 | GS-II | Polity – Personal Laws; Judiciary

No Automatic Share by Birth: Supreme Court on a Grandson's Claim to Grandfather's Property

CONTEXT: The **Supreme Court** held a grandson gets **no automatic share by birth** in his grandfather's property.

1956	Sec 8	Sec 19	2
Hindu Succession Act	Intestate succession	Tenants in common	Schools of Hindu law

1. Case
- Partition suit
- Father sold plot
- Grandson objected

2. Schools
- Mitakshara – by birth
- Dayabhaga – after death
- WB and Assam

3. Law
- Section 8
- Class I heirs
- Section 19

4. Ruling
- No right by birth
- Share = own property
- Sale valid

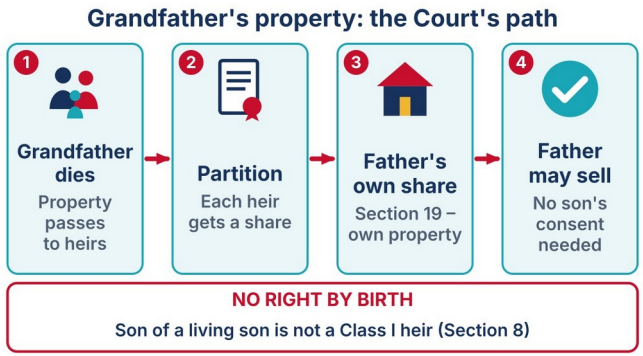


Illustration: how the Court traced the property – from the grandfather, through partition, to the father's own share.

KEY TERMS

Coparcener: Share by birth
Intestate: No will
Class I: First heirs

PRELIMS HOOK

Hindu Succession Act 1956: Sec 8 – intestate succession (Class I heirs including son of a predeceased son, NOT son of a living son); Sec 19 – tenants in common; Mitakshara = right by birth; Dayabhaga (WB, Assam) = no right by birth.

MAINS ANGLE

Personal laws, property rights and judicial interpretation.

PRACTICE (MAINS): Is a grandson entitled by birth to a share in property his grandfather left? Discuss with reference to the 1956 Hindu Succession Act. (150 words)

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TOPIC 4 | GS-II | International Relations – India and its Neighbourhood

India–Bangladesh Ties and the Question of Sheikh Hasina's Return

CONTEXT: Sheikh Hasina's planned return poses a **dilemma** for **India–Bangladesh** ties.

2024	December	1996	2026
Student protests	Planned return	Ganga Treaty signed	Treaty expiry

1. Events
- Passport refused
- Extradition sought
- Death sentence

2. Dhaka
- Protest risk
- Jamaat factor
- Global criticism

3. India
- Ties strained
- Visit cancelled
- Water talks slow

4. Way ahead
- Engage Dhaka
- Separate issues
- Renew water treaty

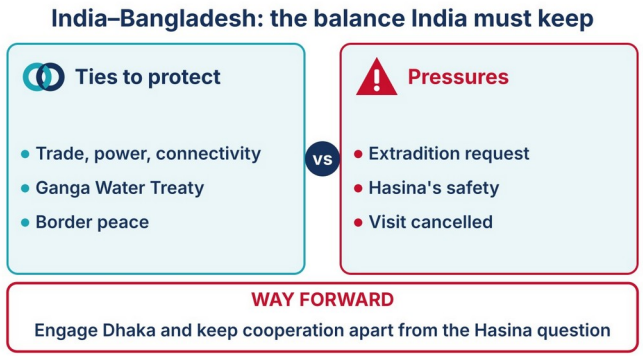


Illustration: the competing pulls India must balance in its ties with Bangladesh.

KEY TERMS
Extradition: Formal handover
Farakka: Ganga sharing point
Petrapole: Land border crossing

PRELIMS HOOK
India–Bangladesh: Sheikh Hasina (Awami League) in India; Dhaka seeks her return under the extradition agreement; Ganga Water Treaty (1996, Farakka) due to expire in 2026; Petrapole land crossing.

MAINS ANGLE
Neighbourhood policy, extradition and humanitarian concerns.

PRACTICE (MAINS): India must balance ties with Bangladesh against its concern for a former leader's safety. Discuss the challenges and suggest a way forward. (250 words)

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TOPIC 5 | GS-II | International Relations – Regional Groupings

23rd ASEAN–India Summit and 21st East Asia Summit in Manila

CONTEXT: The PM heads to **Manila** for the **23rd ASEAN–India Summit** and **21st EAS**.

23rd	21st	11	US$122 bn
ASEAN–India Summit	East Asia Summit	ASEAN members	India–ASEAN trade

1. ASEAN–India
- Since 2002
- 23rd edition
- Manila

2. Focus
- CSP review
- Plan 2026–2030
- Maritime year

3. EAS
- Since 2005
- 19 members
- 21st edition

4. Next hosts
- Philippines 2026
- Singapore 2027
- Thailand 2028



Illustration: the ASEAN–India Summit and the East Asia Summit side by side.

KEY TERMS
CSP: Top-level partnership
EAS: Leaders' forum
Act East: Look to SE Asia

PRELIMS HOOK
23rd ASEAN–India Summit (Manila; annual since 2002; theme 'Navigating Our Future, Together'; 2026 = Year of Maritime Cooperation); 21st EAS – since 2005, first in Kuala Lumpur, 19 members including US and Russia.

MAINS ANGLE
Act East, Indo-Pacific and ASEAN centrality.

PRACTICE (MAINS): How do ASEAN-led forums such as the East Asia Summit serve India's Act East and Indo-Pacific goals? (150 words)

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TOPIC 6 | GS-II | International Relations – India and Sri Lanka

India–Sri Lanka Innovation Forum: Start-ups as a New Bridge

CONTEXT: The **India–Sri Lanka Innovation Forum** was launched in **Colombo** for start-ups and investors.

Colombo	5	2	1
Launched in	Focus sectors	Countries	Business-led platform

1. What
- Business-led
- Informal, continuous
- Colombo launch

2. Functions
- Investor matchmaking
- Mentoring
- Joint R&D to market

3. Sectors
- FinTech, AgriTech
- HealthTech, AI
- Clean mobility

4. Gain
- Market access
- Jobs
- IOR ecosystem

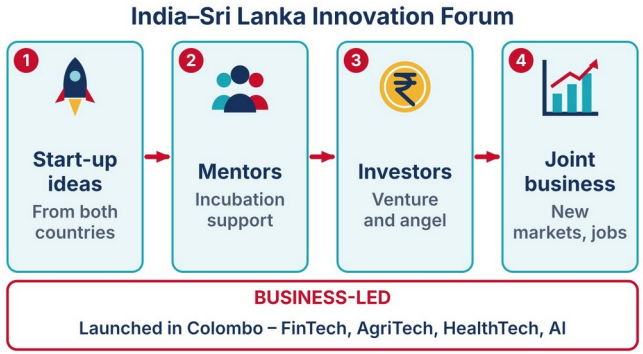


Illustration: how the Innovation Forum turns joint ideas into joint businesses.

KEY TERMS
Incubator: Start-up nursery
VC: Risk capital
Angel: Early investor

PRELIMS HOOK
India–Sri Lanka Innovation Forum – launched in Colombo; informal, business-led platform of start-ups, investors, incubators; sectors FinTech, AgriTech, HealthTech, AI, sustainable mobility.

MAINS ANGLE
Neighbourhood ties through technology and entrepreneurship.

PRACTICE (MAINS): How can technology and start-up cooperation strengthen India's ties with its maritime neighbours? (150 words)

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TOPIC 7 | GS-II | Governance – Health; Reports

WHO Global TB Report 2026: Deaths Down, but India's Incidence Estimate on Hold

CONTEXT: WHO TB Report 2026: India's TB deaths down **38%** since 2015; incidence estimate **on hold**.

10.6 mn	38%	94%	96%
Global cases, 2025	India's death decline	Treatment success	Domestic funding

1. Report
- WHO, annual
- 187 countries
- Estimate vs notified

2. World
- 10.6 mn cases
- 1.13 mn deaths
- Deaths −35%

3. India
- 25.3 lakh cases
- Deaths −38%
- 94% success

4. Next
- Publish data
- AI X-rays
- Contact tracing

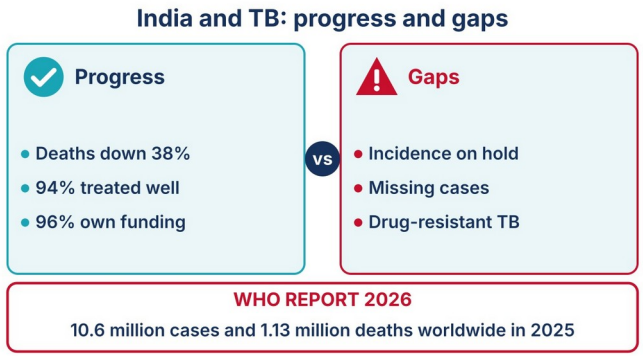


Illustration: where India stands on TB – progress made and gaps still open.

KEY TERMS
Incidence: New cases, estimated
MDR-TB: Drug-resistant TB
Notified: Actually diagnosed

PRELIMS HOOK
WHO Global TB Report 2026: 10.6 mn cases, 1.13 mn deaths (2025); deaths −35% since 2015; India ~¼ of cases, 25.3 lakh notified, deaths −38%, 94% treatment success, 96% domestic funding; incidence estimate under review.

MAINS ANGLE
TB elimination, health data transparency and nutrition support.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "India's TB fight now needs better data as much as better drugs." Discuss. (150 words)

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TOPIC 8 | GS-II | Governance – Education; E-Governance

KVS Goes Digital: Three Platforms for Monitoring, Parents and Alumni

CONTEXT: KVS launched **three digital platforms** for monitoring, parents and alumni.

3	1	In-house	2020
New platforms	AI bot	Built by KVS	NEP alignment

1. VSK
- Live dashboards
- Attendance, results
- Samiksha AI Bot

2. Parents
- KVS-Samvaad
- Results, IDs
- Online certificates

3. Alumni
- Connect portal
- Mentoring
- Career guidance

4. Cautions
- Data privacy
- Digital divide
- AI supports teachers

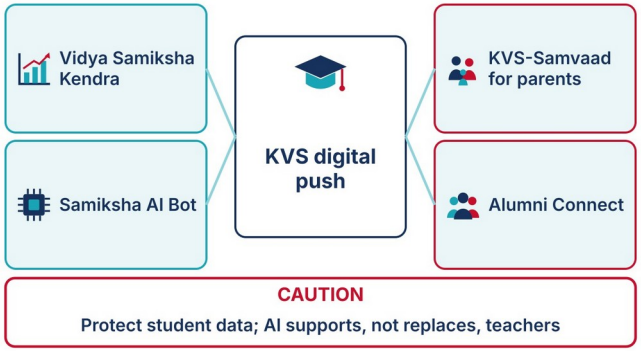


Illustration: the three new KVS digital platforms and who each one serves.

KEY TERMS
VSK: Data dashboard
Samvaad: Parent app
NEP 2020: Education policy

PRELIMS HOOK
KVS digital initiatives (Ministry of Education): AI-integrated Vidya Samiksha Kendra (Samiksha AI Bot), KVS-Samvaad Parent Connect, KVS Alumni Connect Portal; built in-house; aligned with NEP 2020 and Digital India.

MAINS ANGLE
E-governance in education, data privacy and accountability.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Technology can make school governance transparent, but it must protect children's data." Discuss with reference to recent digital initiatives in schools. (150 words)

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TOPIC 9 | GS-III | Infrastructure – Hydropower; Environment; Tribal Rights

Siang Upper Multipurpose Project: Strategic Dam or Threat to the Adi Homeland?

CONTEXT: The **Siang Upper Multipurpose Project** faces **Adi protests** in **Arunachal Pradesh**.

11,000+ MW	9.2 bcm	27	~40%
Planned capacity	Live storage	Villages to be submerged	NE share of hydro potential

1. Project
- Siang (Yarlung Tsangpo)
- NHPC
- PFR stage

2. For
- Flood control
- Hydropower
- Buffer vs Medog

3. Against
- 27 villages submerged
- Ane Siang – sacred
- Zone V risk

4. Way
- Independent EIA
- FPIC
- Modular storages



Photo: the Siang river at Pasighat, Arunachal Pradesh, flowing out of forested hills.

Photo: Rashid Jorvee, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0

KEY TERMS

FPIC: Consent before projects
GLOF: Glacial lake flood
Live storage: Usable water

PRELIMS HOOK

SUMP – Siang (Yarlung Tsangpo), Upper Siang, Arunachal; NHPC; ~11,000–11,200 MW, 9.2 bcm live storage; PFR stage; counter to China's 60,000-MW Medog dam; Adi community – Ane Siang; Seismic Zone V.

MAINS ANGLE

Large dams, indigenous rights, disaster risk and water security.

PRACTICE (MAINS): Examine the strategic case for the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project and the concerns of indigenous communities. How can the two be balanced? (250 words)

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TOPIC 10 | GS-III | Environment – Climate Change; International Negotiations | UPDATE

COP31 in Antalya: From New Promises to Delivery

CONTEXT: COP31 in **Antalya** is judged on **delivering** climate finance, not new promises.

$300 bn	$305 bn	6%	$21 mn
A year by 2035 (NCQG)	Adaptation need a year	Yearly cut UN asks	L&D for Nepal

1. Agenda
- $300 bn by 2035
- Triple adaptation
- 2nd stocktake

2. Leaders
- UN: −6% a year
- Brazil: $1.3 tn
- India: no to pledge

3. Gaps
- Adaptation gap
- Thin L&D fund
- US absent

4. Next
- Deliver finance
- Just transition
- Early warnings

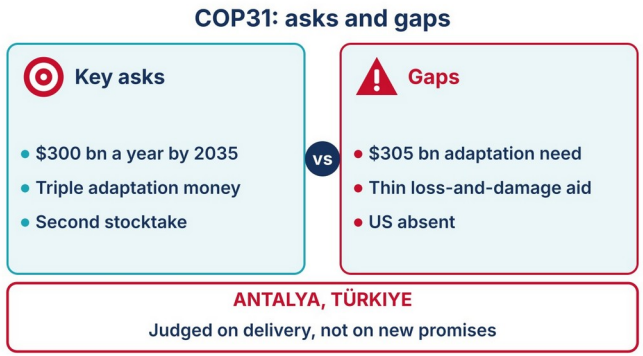


Illustration: COP31's key asks and the gaps that stand in the way.

KEY TERMS
NCQG: $300 bn goal
Stocktake: 5-yearly review
Adaptation: Coping with impacts

PRELIMS HOOK
COP31 – Antalya, Türkiye (host), Australia leads talks; NCQG $300 bn/yr by 2035 (COP29 Baku); triple adaptation finance by 2035; second global stocktake begins; India declined Türkiye's electrification pledge (23% → 35%).

MAINS ANGLE
Climate finance, equity and implementation.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "COP31 will be judged by delivery, not new announcements." Discuss the priorities and gaps in global climate action. (250 words)

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TOPIC 11 | GS-III | Economy – Employment; Skill Development

India's Green Jobs Moment: 1.3 Crore Jobs by 2035 – If the Skills Arrive

CONTEXT: Green sectors could support **1.3 crore jobs by 2035** – if **skills** keep pace.

1.3 crore+	71%	5%	₹60,000 cr
Green jobs by 2035	Thermal roles transferable	Youth with vocational training	PM-SETU outlay

1. Jobs
- 1.3 crore by 2035
- Solar, EVs, recycling
- Small towns

2. Transfer
- 71% thermal roles
- 90% auto roles
- Short bridges

3. Gaps
- 5% vocational
- 81,000 trained
- Old ITIs

4. Fixes
- PM-SETU
- Green skills mission
- Apprenticeships

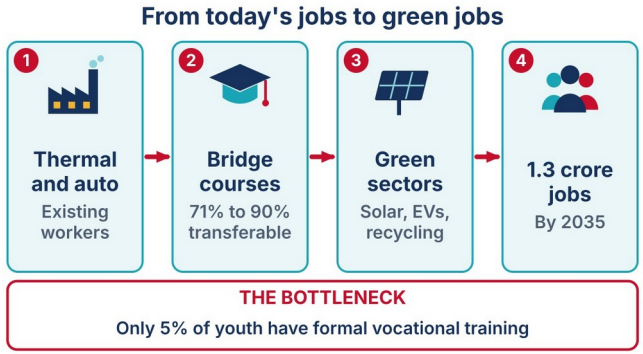


Illustration: the path from today's workers to tomorrow's green jobs – and the skill gaps on the way.

KEY TERMS
RPL: Certify existing skills
ITI: Trade school
PM-SETU: ITI upgrade

PRELIMS HOOK
Green jobs: 1.3 crore+ by 2035 (98.5 lakh by 2030); 71% thermal and 90% auto roles transferable; only 5% youth with formal vocational training; PM-SETU ₹60,000 cr for 1,000 ITIs (200 hubs, 800 spokes); Skill Council for Green Jobs (MSDE).

MAINS ANGLE
Employment, skilling and a just green transition.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "India's green transition can be its biggest job creator if skilling keeps pace." Discuss. (250 words)

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TOPIC 12 | GS-III | Economy – Inflation; Monetary Policy

Retail Inflation Crosses 6%: What the New CPI Measures and What Comes Next

CONTEXT: Retail inflation hit **6.09%** in October, **above the RBI's 6% limit**.

6.09%	4% ± 2	36.75%	358
CPI inflation, Oct 2026	Target band	Food weight	Items in basket

1. Measure
- NSO, MoSPI
- Base 2024 = 100
- 358 items

2. Basket
- Food ~36.75%
- Housing ~17.66%
- Transport ~8.80%

3. Framework
- Sec 45ZA RBI Act
- 4% ± 2%
- 6-member MPC

4. Impact
- Rate hikes likely
- Real incomes fall
- Supply steps

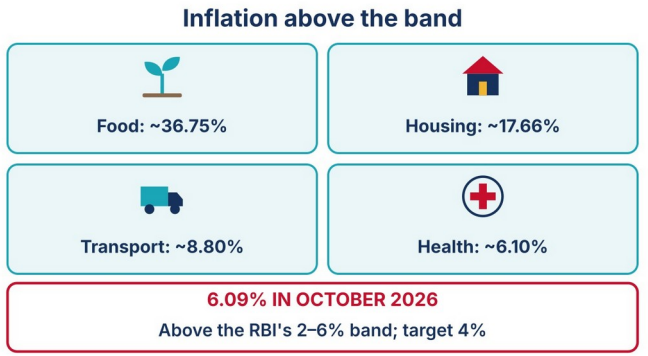


Illustration: the biggest parts of the new CPI basket and the inflation band the RBI must keep to.

KEY TERMS
CPI: Consumer price index
Repo: RBI lending rate
MPC: Rate-setting panel

PRELIMS HOOK
CPI inflation 6.09% (Oct 2026) > 6% upper band; new CPI base 2024 = 100 (NSO, MoSPI), 358 items, food ~36.75%; target 4% ± 2% under Sec 45ZA RBI Act; 6-member MPC; breach for 3 quarters → RBI must report.

MAINS ANGLE
Inflation targeting, food prices and growth.

PRACTICE (MAINS): Inflation has crossed the upper tolerance band. Discuss the policy options before the RBI and the Government. (150 words)

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TOPIC 13 | GS-III | Agriculture / Science & Technology – Crop Protection

Pioxaniliprole: India's First Home-Discovered Insecticide Molecule

CONTEXT: Pioxaniliprole, India's **first home-discovered insecticide**, gets **CIBRC** approval.

1st	20%	4	6
Indian-discovered molecule	w/v strength	Approved crops	Target pests

1. Molecule
- PI Industries
- Diamide class
- 20% SC

2. Action
- Ryanodine receptors
- Calcium flood
- Paralysis

3. Use
- Rice, chilli
- Tomato, chana
- Caterpillar pests

4. Watch
- Resistance
- Pollinators
- Right dose

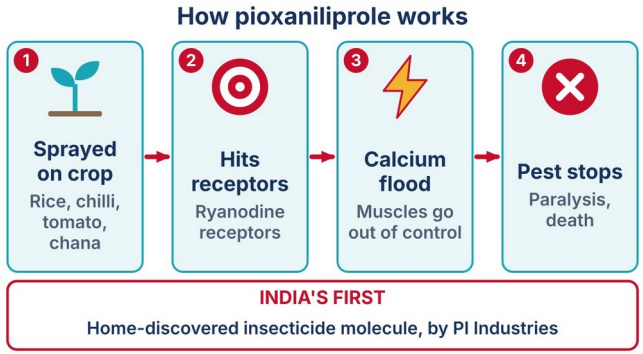


Illustration: how pioxaniliprole stops a caterpillar – from the receptor to paralysis.

KEY TERMS
Diamide: Caterpillar killer class
RyR: Calcium channel
CIBRC: Pesticide approver

PRELIMS HOOK
Pioxaniliprole – India's first indigenously discovered insecticide (PI Industries); anthranilic diamide; acts on ryanodine receptors (calcium release → paralysis); CIBRC approval for rice, chilli, tomato, chana.

MAINS ANGLE
Agri-innovation, import substitution and safe pesticide use.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Home-grown agrochemical innovation must go hand in hand with safe use." Discuss with reference to India's first indigenous insecticide molecule. (150 words)

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TOPIC 14 | GS-III | Environment – Species in News

Rattlepod in Bloom: Munnar's Grasslands Turn Gold

CONTEXT: A rare **mass bloom of rattlepod** turned **Munnar's grasslands** gold.

700+	87	31	15–20
Crotalaria species	In Western Ghats	Endemic to peninsula	Seeds per pod

1. Plant
- Pea family
- Yellow flowers
- Rattling pods

2. Habitat
- Open grasslands
- Up to ~1,200 m
- Pioneer

3. Ecology
- Fixes nitrogen
- Toxic alkaloids
- Butterfly host

4. News
- Yellapatty, Munnar
- Mass bloom
- Eco-tourism

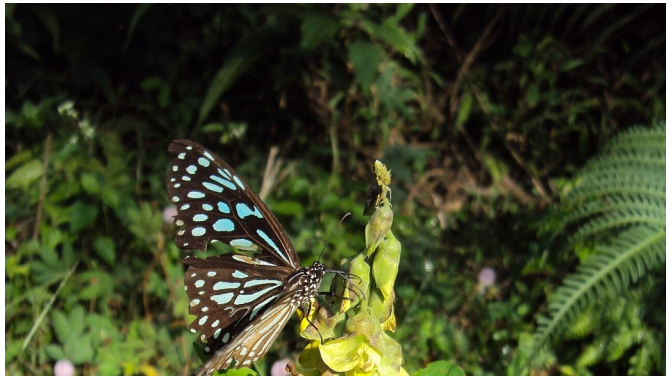


Photo: a Dark Blue Tiger butterfly on the yellow flowers of rattlepod (Crotalaria retusa).
Photo: Vinayaraj, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 3.0

KEY TERMS
Legume: Pea family
Alkaloid: Plant toxin
Pioneer: First coloniser

PRELIMS HOOK
Rattlepod (Crotalaria retusa; kilukilukki) – legume (Fabaceae), fixes nitrogen; toxic pyrrolizidine alkaloids; host to Blue Tiger butterflies; mass bloom at Yellapatty, Munnar (Idukki, Kerala).

MAINS ANGLE
Grassland ecology and species conservation.

PRACTICE (MAINS): Why are grasslands of the Western Ghats ecologically important, and why are they often neglected in conservation? (150 words)

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TOPIC 15 | GS-III | Environment – Protected Areas; Human–Wildlife Conflict

Nawegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve: Tiger Death by Suspected Electrocution

CONTEXT: A tiger died of **suspected electrocution** in **Nawegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve**.

46th Tiger Reserve of India	**5th** In Maharashtra	**702 m** Zenda Pahad	**364** Plant species

1. Where
- Gondia, Bhandara
- Maharashtra
- 46th TR

2. Parts
- Nawegaon NP
- Nagzira WLS
- Koka WLS

3. Links
- Kanha, Pench
- Tadoba-Andhari
- Indravati

4. Threat
- Live wires
- Crop guarding
- Corridor deaths

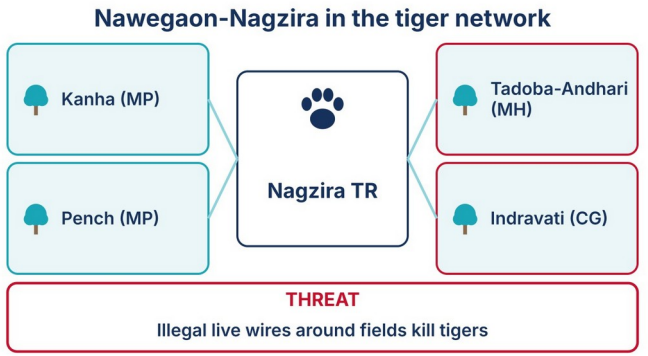


Illustration: Nawegaon-Nagzira's place in the central Indian tiger network and the threat of live wires.

KEY TERMS
Corridor: Forest link
Electrocution: Live-wire death
Buffer: Outer zone

PRELIMS HOOK
Nawegaon-Nagzira TR – Gondia and Bhandara (Maharashtra); 46th TR of India, 5th of Maharashtra; Zenda Pahad (702 m); dry deciduous forest; linked to Kanha, Pench, Tadoba-Andhari, Indravati.

MAINS ANGLE
Tiger corridors and human–wildlife conflict.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Tigers now die more often from humans' wires than from poachers' guns." Discuss the threat of electrocution and suggest remedies. (150 words)

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TOPIC 16 | GS-III | Security – China–Pakistan Military Ties

Karakoram-2026: China and Pakistan's First Regular Army Exercise

CONTEXT: China and Pakistan held their **first regular-army exercise**, **Karakoram-2026**.

1st	2	Xinjiang	3
Regular-army drill	Phases	Venue	Earlier drill series

1. Exercise
- China–Pakistan
- Xinjiang
- First regular army

2. Phases
- Altitude tactics
- Drones
- Live fire

3. For India
- Two-front pressure
- Near Ladakh
- EW, drones

4. Response
- Theatre commands
- Indigenous arms
- Border roads



Illustration: what Karakoram-2026 tested – and what it means for India.

KEY TERMS
EW: Signal warfare
Counter-UAV: Anti-drone
Theatre: Joint command

PRELIMS HOOK
Karakoram-2026 – first China–Pakistan regular-army joint exercise; Xinjiang (borders Ladakh, J&K); earlier drills: Warrior (army counter-terror), Sea Guardian (navy), Shaheen (air force).

MAINS ANGLE
Two-front threat and defence preparedness.

PRACTICE (MAINS): Assess the security implications for India of growing China–Pakistan military coordination. (150 words)

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TOPIC 17 | GS-IV | Ethics – Consent, Development and Indigenous Rights

Ethics Synthesis: Consent for a Survey Is Not Consent for a Dam

CONTEXT: Consent for a survey is **not consent for a dam** – an ethics lesson from the Siang.

FPIC	4	27	1
Consent standard	Core values	Villages at stake	Fair process needed

1. Dilemma
- National need
- Local cost
- Who benefits?

2. Issues
- Coerced signatures
- Welfare as lever
- Trust deficit

3. Values
- Respect
- Transparency
- Fairness

4. Way
- FPIC
- Open data
- Benefit sharing

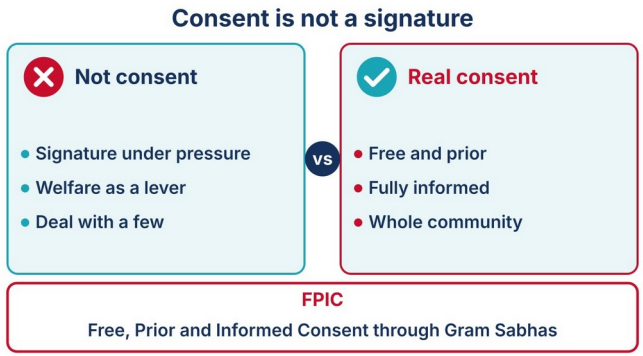


Illustration: real consent versus a mere signature – and what a fair process needs.

KEY TERMS
FPIC: Real consent
Coercion: Pressure voids choice
Procedural justice: Fair process

PRELIMS HOOK
Consent ≠ signature: free, prior, informed consent (FPIC); coercion voids consent; values – respect for persons, transparency, fairness, empathy; procedural and distributive justice.

MAINS ANGLE
Development ethics, consent and trust in governance.

PRACTICE (MAINS): As a District Collector, you find that consent for a project survey was obtained under pressure. What will you do? (250 words)

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